

047. Chapter 4 Verses 11-13

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 4.11

ये यथा मां प्रपद्यन्ते तांस्तथैव भजाम्यहम् ।
मम वर्त्मानुवर्तन्ते मनुष्याः पार्थ सर्वशः ॥ 11 ॥

ye yathā māṃ prapadyante
tāṃstathaiva bhajāmyaham |
mama vartmānuvarta nte
manuṣyāḥ pārtha sarvaśaḥ ||

- ◆ **ye** – who; **yathā** – in whatever way; **mām** – Me; **prapadyante** – surrender/ approach;
- ◆ **tān** – them; **tathā eva** – in that very way; **bhajāmi** – reward/reciprocate; **aham** – I;
- ◆ **mama** – My; **vartma** – path; **anuvartante** – follow;
- ◆ **manuṣyāḥ** – men; **pārtha** – O Partha; **sarvaśaḥ** – in every way.

O Arjuna! In whatsoever form one seeks Me, I reach him in that form, for all mankind are but following the paths I laid down for them.

VERSE 4.12

काङ्क्षन्तः कर्मणां सिद्धिं यजन्त इह देवताः ।
क्षिप्रं हि मानुषे लोके सिद्धिर्भवति कर्मजा ॥ 12 ॥

kāṅkṣantaḥ karmaṇām siddhiṁ
yajanta iha devatāḥ |
kṣipram hi mānuṣe loke
siddhirbhavati karmajā ||

- ◆ **kāṅkṣantaḥ** – longing for; **karmaṇām** – of actions; **siddhiṁ** – success/fruit;
- ◆ **yajante** – worship; **iha** – in this world; **devatāḥ** – the gods;
- ◆ **kṣipram** – quickly; **hi** – indeed; **mānuṣe loke** – in the world of men;
- ◆ **siddhiḥ** – success; **bhavati** – is attained; **karma-jā** – born of action.

Longing for success in action, in this world, (men) worship the deities. For success is quickly attained through action in this world of Man.

VERSE 4.13

चातुर्वर्ण्यं मया सृष्टं गुणकर्मविभागशः ।
तस्य कर्तारमपि मां विद्ध्यकर्तारमव्ययम् ॥ 13 ॥

cāturvarṇyaṃ mayā sṛṣṭaṃ
guṇakarmavibhāgaśaḥ |
tasya kartāramapi mām
viddhyakartāramavyayam ||

- ◆ **cātur-varṇyam** – the four-fold order (Varnas); **mayā** – by Me; **sṛṣṭam** – was created;
- ◆ **guṇa-karma-vibhāgaśaḥ** – according to the distribution of qualities and actions;
- ◆ **tasya** – of that; **kartāram** – the author; **api** – although; **mām** – Me;
- ◆ **viddhi** – know; **akartāram** – the non-doer; **avyayam** – immutable/unchanging.

The four castes were created by Me according to the division of gunas and karma. Though I am their Creator, yet know that I neither act nor change.